

INTERNATIONAL news

US greenlights Tesla-LG \$4.3 billion battery project in Michigan

Tesla and LG Energy Solution will build a \$4.3 billion lithium iron phosphate battery plant in Lansing, Michigan, with production starting in 2027. Cells will power Tesla's Megapack 3 systems. The deal, highlighted at the Indo-Pacific Energy Security Summit, marks one of America's largest LFP investments.

Ford delays US battery plant layoffs amid EV demand slowdown

BlueOval SK, Ford, and SK On's \$11.4 billion EV battery venture has delayed Kentucky layoffs to March 31, 2026, after cutting 1500 jobs earlier. The partnership dissolved in December 2025 amid weak EV demand, with Ford shifting to hybrids and a low-cost electric truck due in 2027.

Sony and TCL form BRAVIA joint venture worth ¥102.8 billion

Sony and TCL have formalised their home entertainment partnership, creating BRAVIA Inc., a Tokyo-based joint venture owned 51% by TCL and 49% by Sony. Valued at ¥102.8 billion (~₹60 billion), the deal includes Sony's Malaysian unit and possibly its Shanghai arm.

Foxconn invests \$136 million to expand in Mexico, eyes AI servers

Foxconn has invested US\$136 million in Mexico through its Singapore arm to expand AI server production, alongside US\$12.72 million in Ingrasys Technology Mexico. Chairman Young Liu projects AI server shipments could double in 2026, reinforcing Foxconn's 40% global market share.

DISTRON expands in-house PCB protection with automation

DISTRON Corporation has expanded US manufacturing with in-house automated conformal coating to support complex PCB assemblies. Using 'Speciality Coating Systems' technology, the process ensures precise application, UV and thermal curing, and scalability from prototypes to full production.

Taiwan's Compal invests \$200 million in US manufacturing hub

Compal Electronics of Taiwan has leased a large facility at Taylor-Port Rail Park near Austin, Texas, and is investing at least US\$200 million to expand its North American manufacturing operations. Operations begin this year, creating 750-900 jobs.

wage hikes amid rising costs. Production was halted, with reports of unrest and police deployment. Dixon's stock dipped 2% intraday, though the company clarified that operations remain unaffected, attributing the protest to broader regional labour issues affecting multiple industries.

Concord Control Systems bags an order worth ₹846.8 million from Indian Railways

Advanced Rail Controls, a Concord Control Systems subsidiary, has secured a ₹846.8 million Indian Railways order for distributed power wireless control systems (DPWCS). Designed for long-haul freight, the technology enables one loco pilot to synchronise multiple locomotives, improving efficiency, traction, and train handling. Following successful trials, deployment will expand across freight corridors. The system aligns with modern 3-phase electric locomotives.

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